

GEORGIA

Georgia — MUN Research Dossier

1. Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	The Republic of Georgia
Short Form	Georgia
Capital	Tbilisi
Region (UN)	Eastern Europe
Government Type	Unitary parliamentary republic
Head of State	Salome Zourabichvili, President
Head of Government	Irakli Kobakhidze, Prime Minister
Currency	Georgian Lari (GEL)
UN Member Since	1992
MUN Standing	Often a vocal participant on security, territorial integrity, human rights, and regional cooperation issues, especially relating to Russian aggression and regional conflicts.

Book Recommendations

1. **"Georgia: A Political History Since Independence"** – Stephen F. Jones
2. **"The Making of Modern Georgia, 1918–2012"** – Edited by Stephen F. Jones
3. **"Conflict in the Caucasus: Implications for International Legal Order"** – Svante E. Cornell
4. **"Russia and the New States of Eurasia"** – Karen Dawisha & Bruce Parrott
5. **"Frozen Conflicts in the Caucasus"** – Thomas de Waal (Carnegie Endowment reports)

Research Table: Georgia & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UNHRC – Georgia Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/georgia	Official UN Human Rights page with reports and updates.
UPR Info – Georgia	https://www.upr-info.org/en/review/Georgia	Universal Periodic Review details, recommendations, and follow-ups.
National Human Rights Strategy – Georgia	https://www.ombudsman.ge/eng	Office of the Public Defender of Georgia (Ombudsman) official site.
Human Rights Watch – Georgia	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/georgia	Monitoring of civil liberties and state practices.

Amnesty International – Georgia	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/georgia/	Independent evaluations of civil, political, and minority rights.
UN Special Rapporteurs on Georgia	https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures-human-rights-council	Special procedures and thematic reports involving Georgia.
Freedom House – Georgia Report	https://freedomhouse.org/country/georgia/freedom-world/2023	Evaluation of press freedom, rule of law, and political rights.
Council of Europe – Georgia	https://www.coe.int/en/web/tbilisi	Involvement in ECHR and democratic institution-building.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Georgia Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/georgia (hrw.org)	Baseline information on treaty ratifications, OHCHR engagement, and UNHRC oversight.
OHCHR – Georgia UPR Index & Docs	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/ge-index	Centralized access to official UPR reports, stakeholder inputs, and recommendations.
UPR Infographic 2021 (PDF)	https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/lib-docs/HRBodies/UPR/Documents/Session37/GE/Infographic.pdf	Visual summary of Georgia's 2021 review—useful for quick UNHRC context.
HRW – UPR Submission (2020 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=8309	NGO critique addressing justice system, media freedoms, policing—core UNHRC themes.
Government Mid-Cycle UPR Report (2018 PDF)	https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&filename=8244	Tracks progress on prior recommendations—a key UNHRC follow-up tool.
OHCHR – Treaty Reporting Status	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/countries.aspx?CountryCode=GEO&Lang=en	Shows which core human rights treaties Georgia has ratified and reported on.
OHCHR – Anti-Discrimination Legal Opinion (PDF)	https://www.ohchr.org/Documents/Issues/Racism/AdHoc/6thSession/Georgia.pdf	UN guidance for legal reform to protect ethnic and

		religious minority rights.
OHCHR – Cooperation & Follow-up Summary (PDF)	https://reliefweb.int/report/georgia/cooperation-georgia-report-united-nations-high-commissioner-human-rights-ahrc5480-enarruzh	Details ongoing OHCHR work in education, justice, anti-discrimination.
OHCHR – Special Rapporteur Visits	https://spinternet.ohchr.org/ViewCountryVisits.aspx?Lang=en&country=GEO&visitType=all	Lists expert visits on torture, assembly, racial discrimination—indicative of UN scrutiny.
U.S. State Dept – 2023 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/georgia/	Addresses civic space, media restrictions, prosecution, and labor rights.
HRW – World Report 2024 (Georgia)	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/georgia	Highlights media crackdowns, protests, LGBT rights erosion.
HRW – World Report 2025 (Georgia)	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2025/country-chapters/georgia	Documents foreign agent law, violent protest suppression, and legal rollback.
Freedom House – Georgia Profile 2024	https://freedomhouse.org/country/georgia/freedom-world/2024	Provides civil and political liberties ratings essential for UNHRC analysis.
UPR Info – Georgia Hub	https://upr-info.org/en/review/georgia	Independent access to UPR documents, complementing OHCHR's data.
HRW – Foreign Agents Law Campaign (2025)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2025/03/26/georgia-drop-repressive-foreign-agents-bill	Press release urging Council-level action against foreign-agent legislation.
HRW – Mass-Protest Crackdown (Dec 2024)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2024/12/10/georgias-human-rights-crisis-deepens-amid-mass-protests	Confirms violent dispersal of EU-accession protests—adds to UN civil rights priority.

Civil.ge – Analysis of HRW Findings	https://civil.ge/archives/652965	Local reporting on HRW critiques—illustrates UNHRC interactions.
UPR Submission – Education International (2011 PDF)	https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/lib-docs/HRBodies/UPR/Documents/Session10/GE/EI_EducationInternational-eng.pdf	Focuses on human-rights teaching and academic freedom—ties to Item 4.
OHCHR Letter to Georgia on UPR Engagement (2021 PDF)	https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/2021-11/HC_letter_to_Georgia.pdf	Official communication assessing Georgia's engagement with UPR process.

10 Unique Aspects: Georgia at UNHRC

1. **Foreign-Agent Legislation Crisis:** Georgia's shift in 2024 towards laws that resemble “foreign agent” regulations has sparked direct criticism from the UN Human Rights Council and has mobilized various NGOs.
2. **Violent Crackdowns on EU-Accession Protests:** In late 2024 and into 2025, peaceful protests faced harsh responses, including tear gas and rubber bullets, which prompted several interventions from the UN Human Rights Council and the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights.
3. **Media Freedom Under Pressure:** HRW is shining a light on the growing challenges faced by journalists and media organizations, which has become a key issue in the discussions surrounding Council Item 2.
4. **Minority & Anti-Discrimination Legal Reform:** The expert opinion from OHCHR advocates for enhanced legal protections for Roma and ethnic minorities, especially as they come under greater scrutiny from the UN.
5. **Weak Follow-Up on UPR Recommendations:** The latest government mid-cycle report indicates that progress is lacking, highlighting ongoing challenges with the UNHRC's follow-up processes.
6. **UN Expert Visits Highlight Civil Liberties Gap:** Numerous SR missions on assembly, torture, and discrimination indicate Georgia's review under Council scrutiny
7. **Rights Education in Schools Push:** Efforts to weave rights into the curriculum—highlighted in Education International's UPR input.
8. **Shrinking NGO & Civic Space:** HRW's reports indicate that certain laws and administrative hurdles are hindering the freedom of association, which has caught the attention of the Council.
9. **Elections Undermine Democratic Norms:** The decline in rights following the election and the withdrawal from the EU signal a troubling shift away from democratic values—something that's been a point of concern during UNHRC meetings.
10. **Council-Level Activism by HRW & OHCHR:** The letters from OHCHR and the alerts from HRW play a crucial role in Council sessions, highlighting that Georgia is very much an active topic on the agenda.